

ring an incident

<details><summary>Going Dark</summary>

When an incident occurs, it may be appropriate for the social team to pause all brand channel social posts. This is called "going dark", and is a regular part of evaluating whether or not company messaging is appropriate to share at any given time. It is considered good practice to minimize the digital space brands occupy on social media during these times. This can help to not distract social conversation but can also reduce the probability of being accidentally caught up in conversation unintentionally, sounding tone-deaf, or otherwise coming across as insensitive.

When this occurs, time-sensitive posts will be the first to be rescheduled. In the event time-sensitive posts could not be rescheduled, the social team will do what we can to update our stakeholders on what posts won't be published. Non-time sensitive posts will be moved to Sprout drafts, which can then be rescheduled at a later time.

Going dark could have a negative impact on social metrics, depending on the severity and length of time we're dark. Going dark could also negatively impact specific CTAs if we're relying on organic social to perform. These considerations are a part of making the decision and will be communicated as often as appropriate.

</details>

<details><summary>Rewriting copy or switching assets</summary>

It may be necessary to update copy or assets depending on cultural impact during an incident. The social team reserves the agency to do this as we see necessary, however, we will communicate the changes to our stakeholders if we'd consider the changes to be major.

The above template is also located in Sprout for quick access.

</details>

<!-- Social Marketing Handbook - ref <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/marketing/issues/524> -->
<!-- identifiers, in alphabetical order -->

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/social-marketing/admin.md

{{% alert color="info" %}}

.. This page is the single source of truth for all administrative tasks, templates, and project management needs focused on GitLab brand social channels. If your question is "how?", the answer will be here.

{{% /alert %}}

Social Media Project Management

Epic Roadmap

Issue Board by Milestone
Issue Board by Assignee

Requesting Social Promotion

Many requests for social media coverage could sound like one ask, but ultimately have different end-user objectives or where we'll need to promote different assets or links. Please keep the following in mind to help us better manage requests.

Open a new issue to request social coverage

{{% alert color="info" %}}

· For anything to get promoted on social, there must be a dedicated social issue. Most campaigns with multiple activation points also require an epic. Not sure what you need? Message the team in the socialmediaaction Slack channel.

{{% /alert %}}

Head to the corporate marketing project and create a new issue with the best template below.

General Request Templates

General Request
Listening Report Requests
Reporting Requests

Event Request Templates

Epic: GitLab Events
Issue: GitLab Owned Event Template for CFP, Reg, or Engagement
Issue: 3rd Party Sponsored Event Request

GTM Templates

GTM Coverage Epic
GTM Coverage Issue for each tactic

Other Specialized Templates

Case Study Promotion
Partner Marketing Support

Things to remember about social media requests

- Sometimes it is not possible to schedule posts when desired due to any number of reasons, but the social team will work with you to make sure you're supported.
- The social team reserves the right to not publish for a myriad of reasons including crisis moments, calendar priorities, and other elements. We'll do our best to explain why when asked.
- If you haven't done so already, consider GitLab's Social Advocacy Program as an additional resource for amplification. Advocacy allows your marketing messages to be given to GitLab Team Members to share on their own personal social media channels. If your team does not have a

designated curator, you can suggest the piece of content through Bambu for approval.

Request workflows

- When a social media issue template is used, the requestor is required to fill in as much info as they have that is appropriate to fulfill the request.
- Issues are automatically assigned to the @social group, which contains the entire social team and is added to the social media - triage milestone.
- A member of the social team will see the issue in their to-do's, and can either pick up the issue to work on themselves or discuss it with other team members about who is best equipped to fulfill the request.
- The team member who is going to do the work unassigns other team members and leaves themselves as the only assignee.
- Team member considers timelines, workloads, event dates, and other information to then assign the issue to a mktg: 202x-xx-xx milestone according to when the work is expected to be completed or when there needs to be another touchpoint between the social team and the requestor. Milestones are best viewed on an Issue Board like this one. This expresses a timeline easier to understand workloads.
- Adding a due date is only required when the milestone selected is not when the work will be delivered, so in the event the milestone is another touchpoint. Some requestors may add a due date themselves. If the date needs to change from what the requestor selected, simply tag them in a comment and let them know why it has changed.

Blog coverage workflow

GitLab's blogs play a vital role in brand social's success, particularly from the POV of topics that go deep into technical specifics. While we do not share posts for 100% of blogs published, we do share approx. 90% of blogs that are published. There is no set of determining factors as to which blogs we ought to share which we don't share. These specifics are subjective and usually accompanied by details from the editorial team that help us to understand the context of the blog. E.g., if a blog is published solely for SEO or other marketing needs, the content of the blog is likely to be useless for the majority of social followers, so we'll decide to skip it. On the opposite side, if a blog is tied to a GTM campaign, these are almost always shared on brand social due to usually being true-top-of-funnel content that social audiences would benefit from. From the social perspective, the critical question to answer is, "would our audiences benefit from seeing a link to this blog? How?".

Below is the workflow for publishing blogs on brand social channels.

- Social team member sees new blogs in the content-updates Slack channel
- Social team member takes the link and heads to Sprout's publishing settings to set the UTMs: <https://app.sproutsocial.com/settings/publishing/>
- Under URL tracking, click "+add url"
- Set the parameter for campaign and save it. For basic blogs, the campaign is blog. If it can be (or is explicitly) tied to a marketing campaign, use that campaign utm. e.g., 10years, seeingisbelieving, devopsplatform. If you are unsure, ask the editorial team inside the Slack thread for the blog.
- Head to Sprout's publishing tab: <https://app.sproutsocial.com/publishing/>, and schedule blog content. When you add the URL of the blog to the post, it will automatically add UTMs based on the channel and use the preconfigured campaign UTM from above.

Key parameters on sharing blogs

- Suggested copy is provided by the editorial team via the "click to tweet" box at the bottom of every blog. Please feel free to use this copy directly or tweak as desired. If there is not a "click to tweet" box at the bottom of the blog, consider reviewing paragraphs 1 and 2, as well as the last paragraph of the blog, for copy ideas
- Schedule each blog at least 1x across Twitter, Facebook, and LinkedIn, unless the blog would only benefit from key niche audiences on specific channels (e.g. community-oriented posts for Twitter, or job related ones on LinkedIn). Our audiences do have a great amount of cross-pollination, so many blogs will make sense across channels.
- Consider scheduling additional timeslots 2-8 weeks ahead of your first scheduled posts. E.g. a new product launch, timed details are included with end dates, etc. If there are weeks between posts, using the same copy is fine. However, if these posts would appear back-to-back week over week, consider editing the copy to be different.
- General blog coverage without subjective needs added may look like this:
 - Copy 1 scheduled on FB, TW, LI
 - Copy 1 scheduled on TW again in 2 weeks
 - Copy 2 scheduled on FB, TW, and LI approx 4 weeks from the original scheduled date above.
- Unless dates/times require specific publishing time windows, the specific publishing volume and timelines aren't as important as it is to dynamically create variability in our content and our topics by mixing blogs and topics with other posts.

Organic Social and GTM Motions

The social team does not create or own the core messaging for GTMs. We'll take campaign manager approved messaging, apply the GitLab tone of voice, and include social practices.

We use the following workflow to make sure teams are aligned and able to organize effectively.

Social and GTM Two-Step Process

Requesting the work

GTM Campaign Manager should create a new issue, fill out the details, and attach issue to GTM tactic child epic. This means that for each new piece of content (or tactic), there should be a new social request issue.

Social GTM Request Issue

Recording the work once it's done

For each new reporting period (Quarter or Half); the social team will open a new organic social child epic. We'll use this child-epic as a repo after the work on an issue is completed. Since tactics (webinar, whitepaper, etc) each have their own child-epic already, we'll execute the work with an issue attached to these epics, close the issue and move to our social epic for record keeping.

Social GTM Child Epic Code

Data needed on pages in order for links to work on social media

In order for links to be successfully shared on social media, there are a few elements that are required to include in GitLab-owned pages including the handbook, all marketing website links, and even "3rd-party" sites we operate like Meetup, Hopin, and other sites for user registration and events.

These elements help to populate the opengraph, sometimes called a social sharing card.

The social team may reject any request to share links in social posts that do not include these elements

There are a number of reasons these elements are required. These elements...

- are more inclusive due to the nature of the elements - providing additional text to describe links in place of being able to understand the content visually
- aid in building more "Social SEO", making the link more searchable on social media channels
- utilize the basic features that express a link on social networks (titles, descriptions, images, and alt text)

The elements are:

- Page title
- Page description
- a unique-to-page-content image
- "alt text" that describes the above image for the hearing impaired
- Twitter specific elements that help the channel identify authors and make our links more discoverable

See below for code that can be added to the frontmatter of all pages. If you're using a "3rd-party" GitLab owned instance like Hopin or Meetup, these sites automate this need when you attach a core image, include a title in the event/page, and other elements.

Adding an image embed to links for sharing on social media

No matter the circumstance, the social team will need a visual asset to accompany our posts. In many cases, it's most effective and time efficient if these images were created with the linked page development and added to the frontmatter before publicizing the link to teams who need to use it for promotional efforts. When there is not an image already embedded in the frontmatter of a page that GitLab owns or operates, the social team can either spend time creating our own images or reject the request. In many cases, it won't be an appropriate use of time for the social team to create our own images.

Canva Enterprise Account

Consider using an existing template in our Canva Enterprise account as these images have been approved to use.

Templates

- Generic Website Template
- Generic Brand Template
- Brand Specific Content with Photo Template
- Website Specific Content with Photo Template
- Big Announcement Template

Need help? Reach out to socialmediaaction Slack channel.

Adding Frontmatter to GitLab-owned pages for proper social sharing

When sharing a link on social media, all channels will look for opengraph frontmatter information, allowing the sites to pull a social media sharing card. This includes unique specifics for the page like its title, a description, and a unique image. It's critical that all pages intended to be shared across social media sites have this information attached, so that our users are aware of where we're linking them to, as well as, following best practices.

Social Media Sharing tags are set by the post or page frontmatter. Please use the following template and add it to the frontmatter:

```
<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
Frontmatter template
</summary>

<pre><code><span class="hljs-symbol">title:</span> your page title/cta
<span class="hljs-symbol">description:</span> page description
<span class="hljs-symbol">twitterimage:</span> <span class="hljs-string">"/images/opengraph/file-name.png"</span>
<span class="hljs-symbol">twitterimagealt:</span> <span class="hljs-string">"describe the image
being used here"</span>
<span class="hljs-symbol">twittersite:</span> <span class="hljs-string">"gitlab"</span>
<span class="hljs-symbol">twittercreator:</span> <span class="hljs-string">"gitlab"</span>
</code></pre>
</details>
```

Be sure to update the title, description, twitterimage, twitteraltimage, and other non-social tags necessary for your page. The twittersite and twittercreator tags should remain the static value: "@gitlab"

Description

The description meta tag is important for SEO, but it's also a part of Facebook and Twitter social cards. The description should be a short summary of the page. You can think of this as a subtitle.

The description is not meant to repeat the post or page title, use your creativity to describe the content of the post or page. Try to make your description less than 100 characters, if possible.

Twitterimage

Adding an image file to the frontmatter for twitterimage should be added to the [www-gitlab-com] project at /images/opengraph/ and must be named after the page's file name. While listed as an image for Twitter, this code works for all social sharing sites.

Twitterimage-alt

It is important to be as inclusive as possible, which is why providing an alternative text for your image is necessary. Image alt's provide a written summary of what is in the image for users who prefer to be read what is in the image vs seeing it, think of users who use screenreaders to read social media. Text included here should not repeat the title or description and it is not another way to add additional SEO properties - you should simply describe the image. Is the picture a group of GitLab Team Members gathering at Contribute New Orleans? Then that is your image alt text.

Static frontmatter like twittersite and twittercreator

This frontmatter aides sites like twitter in understanding how to present additional content. When the link is shared on Twitter, a user may see content that Twitter believes is related to the one shared. This is more of an administrative tag that assists on the backend. These values will always be the same and do not require you to update them.

Testing frontmatter

Frontmatter requires a merge, therefore, you'll need to include this as a step in page creation. Once merged, please test your link. Preview the social cards by adding your link to the [Twitter Card Validator], or the [Facebook Debugger].

UTMs for tracking URLs

UTMs are used to track traffic sources & reach of posts/links. All posts that contain GitLab-owned URLs must contain a UTM parameter.

Organic Social Media UTM Creating Sheet

Organic Social Media UTM Creating Sheet (internal)

The social team manages their own social media UTM tracking sheet. Viewable to all parties, this sheet is managed only by the social media team.

Other UTMs for Tracking

Please see details in the Digital Marketing handbook. In short, it's important to outline UTM campaign, content, and other variables if you're looking to measure more deeply. Campaign section is a requirement, and is likely connected to your ongoing marketing campaign. If you have questions or are unsure how to tag a URL please reach out to the Digital Marketing team &/or the Social Media Manager responsible for the campaign.

Links in bio with LinkTree

LinkTree is bio link tool. The Social Media team uses LinkTree to drive traffic to the GitLab

website. Folks will click the link in bio and have a few options to choose from before landing on a webpage. The GitLab brand Linktree is: <https://linktr.ee/GitLab>

At GitLab we have multiple CTA's and campaign goals. The idea here is that a LinkTree will give our community an exit route and determine themselves- on where they land. Once you click the link in bio you'll have tiles to choose from: Homepage, Handbook, Press, Blog, Get a Free Trial, etc. Tile options are a continuous iteration as they will change to reflect current campaigns.

LinkTree credentials are managed via the Social Media Vault in 1 Password. Links in the LinkTree would need to be approved by the social team, as these links are considered inventory for organic social.

Labels

Consider our labels as a way to be transparent about our work at every level of our marketing organization. At any given time and at any given level, a Team Member can recall what volume and mix of work is happening. Not only does this help the social team to better organize, but would allow our Team Members up our organization to better understand their entire team, too.

Required Labels

Every social media-related issue should have the following labels, each of which covers our organization in a broader look further up the chain.

Organizing by line of work

- ~"Social Media" (our team)
- ~"Corp Comms" (our department)
- ~"Corporate Marketing" (our organization)

Organizing by status of work

- ~"mktg-status::plan" (net-new issues, not yet accepted to work on)
- ~"mktg-status::wip" (issues that have been accepted by a member of our team, added to a milestone)
- ~"mktg-status::review" (issues where the social media team have delivered "proofs" of posts to stakeholder for approval)
- ~"mktg-status::scheduled" (issues where the social media posts are approved, added to Sprout calendar, and the issue can be closed)
- ~"mktg-status::blocked" (when the social team is waiting on additional information, assets, or other needs and cannot yet complete the work in the issues)

Optional Labels

More on optional labels will be available soon.

Giveaways on Social Media

Giveaways Process

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
Pre-Giveaway
</summary>

Contact the social media team in the socialmediaaction Slack channel to discuss the details and thoughts about the giveaway. If it makes sense, we can commit to supporting the giveaway following legal approval in step 2 below.
Work with the legal team to review and approve the promotional game. You can find more info on what legal requires here in the handbook. Alternatively, you can head right to the promotional game review issue template to file an issue for legal approval.
Once approved, create an issue and tag the Social Marketing Manager to determine the rules of engagement and the Corporate Events Manager for prizes.
Create and publish an Official Sweepstakes Rules page

</details>

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
How to Create an Official Sweepstakes Rules Page </summary>

Create a new directory in <code>/source/community/sweepstakes</code> in the www-gitlab-com project. Name the directory the same as the giveaway <code>/source/community/sweepstakes/name-of-giveaway</code>
Add an index.html.md file to the <code>/name-of-giveaway/</code> folder
Add the content of the Terms and Conditions provided by Legal during your Pre-Giveaway process to the <code>index.html.md</code> file.
Create merge request and publish.

</details>

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
Post-Giveaway </summary>

Winners must sign an Affidavit of Eligibility & Liability, Indemnity, and Publicity Release. Use the "Affidavit of Eligibility - Sweepstakes" template found on the google drive.
Announce the winners

<p>Find out more about the swag giveaways here.</p>

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Creating the Campaign </summary>

Set a launch date

Ask for social image(s) with text (if organic posts only) explaining the offer/ask

Set an initial deadline for submissions, so you can have multiple pushes at interval & ramp up energy

Finalize the delivery method: form vs. tweets vs. retweets, depending on the goals of the campaign

Pros of a form: Neat, uniform, easy for us to keep track of, no downsides of low engagement (i.e., responses not visible)

Pros of asking for submissions via Twitter: we could more easily RT cool responses, get more out of a hashtag, etc.

Pros of asking for RTs in exchange for swag: very little backend to do on social afterwards, except to announce the winners of swag

Finalize the ask, making sure it's extremely clear what you want to happen (<code>Share your GitLab story!</code> <code>Tell us your favorite thing you made with GitLab</code>

<code>tell us a time GitLab helped you out of a tight spot</code>)

Make sure the ask can be intuitively communicated via whichever delivery method you're using, i.e., the tweet doesn't need to explain everything if you're pointing to a form or blog post. If you're not pointing to anything, make sure the tweet plus possible image text must make sense by themselves. Use threads for more space!

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Pre-Launch </summary>

Finalize the timeline for when the reminders/follow-ups will go out, add to social schedule and leave some space around them to RT/engage with responses

Finalize copy for all pushes

If swag is involved, create a google sheet with swag codes from the Event Marketing Manager

Finalize hashtag

Ask community advocates to review all copy (tweets, form, blog post) and adjust according to their suggestions

Make sure the community advocates are aware of the campaign timeline/day-of

Designate a social point person to be "on duty" for the day-of and one person who can serve as backup

Let the broader GitLab team know that the social campaign is upcoming and ask for their support

</details>

Day of giveaway

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>
Day of Giveaway </summary>

If you have entries for the giveaway in a spreadsheet, use random.org to generate a random number. Match the number to the corresponding row in your spreadsheet to identify the winner. Never enter email addresses or personal information of participants into a third-party site or system we do not control.

Try to schedule first push or ask a team member to tweet the first announcement early (ex: around 4 am PT) to try to have some overlap with all our timezones

If you're asking for RTs in exchange for swag, make sure there's a clearly communicated cut-off to indicate that the giveaway will not stretch into perpetuity. One day-long is probably the longest you want a giveaway to stretch, or you can limit to number of items.

Plan to engage live with people

If your promise was to give away one hoodie per 25 RTs, do it promptly after that milestone is crossed. It adds to the excitement and will get more people involved

Announce each giveaway and use handles whenever possible, tell them to check their DMs

DM the swag codes or whatever the item is

In your copy, directly address the person/people like you are chatting with them irl

RT and use GIFs with abandon but also judgment

</details>

After the Giveaway

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>
After the Giveaway </summary>

Thank everyone promptly, internal & external

Write in the logistics issue of any snags that came up or anything that could've gone better

Amend hb as necessary for next time

</details>

Sprout Social

Tagging

Tag a post after its been published

Tags in Sprout enable social to measure performance outside of general level metrics. If a post needs a tag but did not get one when scheduled, we'll need to tag the posts after they've been published. While this can happen from forgetting to add the tag in Sprout, its most often related to publishing natively on channels. E.g. when we use Twitter Ads/Media Center to publish unique card content or when publishing stories in Instagram.

To tag a post after its been published:

1. head to the reports tab
1. select the cross-network reports category
1. choose the post performance report
1. use channel and publishing date filters to find the posts you're looking for
1. click the outline of the tag icon , select the tag(s) for the post; the tag icon will now be blue to indicate there are tags added

Other administrative items

LinkedIn Events

Our LinkedIn Events strategy is to raise attendance from x to xx or from xx to xxx for events that would otherwise not get recognition elsewhere or when they are critical to our brand marketing efforts.

LinkedIn Events are a great way to expand awareness of GitLab ran events. LinkedIn Page Admins can use LinkedIn Events to bring their professional community together safely and in real-time. Only page admins have the ability to create events under the GitLab brand LinkedIn page.

Not every event at GitLab should have a LinkedIn Event landing page. We should be highly selective to field marketing and corporate marketing efforts. If we determine specific events for GTMs or other topics would be of interest to the community, we can add those events on a case-by-case basis.

It's also important to consider the user journey, by using a LinkedIn Event page we are adding steps to registering for an event. Therefore, when an event has an appropriate landing or registration page, especially if these pages offer rich insight to the event happenings, the need for a LinkedIn Event page becomes smaller.

It is currently unclear if performance inside of LinkedIn Events produces measureable results inside of the social team's reporting structure. In the event this data is not present, it will be difficult to decide on using LinkedIn Events for corporate events due to the lack of performance data associated with the event page itself.

LinkedIn Event Speaker Line Up

In order for a speaker to be added to a LinkedIn Event, they will need to be personally connected to the admin that stands up the event page. You may know who you're working with to do this already, so it would be best to inform your speaker(s) to anticipate an invite to connect from someone on the GitLab social media team.

Required elements for a LinkedIn Event page

All of the following elements should be coming from the team member who is the event organizer. The social team is not responsible for creating a brand and purpose for the event.

- Event name (up to 75 characters)
- Start/End date and time in a specific timezone (LinkedIn will convert to the users local timezone when it appears to them)
- A description of the event - answering the who, what, where, when, and why of the event (up to 5,000 characters)
- Registration link for users (remember to shorten the link with a bit.ly and consider adding UTM tracking specific to LinkedIn Event page for tracking)

Optional items for LinkedIn Events

- Unique-to-event profile image (1:1 ratio)
- Unique-to-event banner image (4:1 ratio or 1584 x 296)

If these elements aren't provided or necessary, the event imagery will be whatever the current GitLab brand profile default is at the time.

Check out the LinkedIn Events FAQs provided by LinkedIn [here](#).

Non-social team admin access to select social channels

In some instances, GitLab team members who are not on the social team will have administrative access to a social channel. This makes sense when team members manage paid social advertising, create events, or handle reporting as part of their roles.

All team members, including those on the social team, who have access to an admin console on any social channel will need to prove that their accounts are secured with 2FA, preferably with an app or code generator and not their mobile device. We recommend using 1 Password, which we have access to as team members of GitLab.

When admin access is granted on channels where the available permission settings are above what is necessary for non-social team members to successfully run their tasks, there will be explicit guidelines from the social team on what and where to click and to manage so that non-social team members do not accidentally interfere with social operations.

With the availability to post to a channel, respond to users, or edit company information, comes serious risk in damaging our brand in the eyes of the community, our team, the media, investors, or other stakeholders. It's not about preventing silly mistakes, this is focused on protecting GitLab, our team members, and our community from malicious activity or other damage

that could reflect on the company.

Field Marketing team access to LinkedIn events feature

- View the field marketing LinkedIn admin for events quick training video

View the field marketing LinkedIn admin for events quick training video on private Unfiltered channel

The field marketing team is enabled to use the GitLab brand LinkedIn channel to create events, so that GitLab is seen as the event organizer. If you need to connect with who the field marketing LinkedIn events admin is, please message the social team in the socialmediaaction Slack channel.

The field marketing events admin can only create, edit, and maintain the events listings on the GitLab LinkedIn page and they are not authorized to write posts, edit the page or its contents, or to respond to users.

Events that are authorized to be promoted as organized by the GitLab brand include demos, webinars, speaker sessions, Connect, Commit, and other virtual and in-person events that the GitLab brand and company can and will fully support.

Events that are not authorized to be promoted as organized by the GitLab brand include: team member celebrations, non-GitLab hosted events, events where a partner is the lead and already have an event page, and promoting events or campaigns that use social good initiatives for lead generation.

LinkedIn events should only be used for events and not for campaigns. Events are defined as a specific moment in time on a calendar in which the expectation is that users will join synchronously. Campaigns are defined as initiatives that run for a longer than a specific moment in time and where users can participate asynchronously.

Social channel colors

Please use the following hex colors to represent the channels in reports, in charts, or when calling it out in plain text.

- Facebook - 1778F2
- Insta - 8A3AB9
- LI - 0E76A8
- Twitter - 1DA1F2

Social Media Profile assets

Social Media profile assets would include profile images and banners. Banners are specific to each site and should include the latest best practices in dimensions and care for where designs appear in the asset, so that they are visible on desktop and on mobile properly. This Google Drive folder includes existing approved assets. Note, this folder is only accessible to the communications and brand design team at this time.

User Generated Content confirmation

The following code is required when asking for team members or anyone in the wider community to submit elements that the social team intends to create content around. Please include this on rules pages or in Google Forms, or in any location where we'd be asking for content from users.

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

UGC Disclosure </summary>

```
<pre><code>By submitting this [INSERT WHAT WE<span class="hljs-symbol">'RE</span> ASKING <span class="hljs-keyword">FOR</span> <span class="hljs-keyword">AND</span> <span class="hljs-keyword">WITH</span>; GOOGLE FORM, ETC] <span class="hljs-keyword">with</span> answers <span class="hljs-keyword">or</span> uploading a video response, you are providing perpetual consent <span class="hljs-keyword">to</span> GitLab Inc., its affiliates, subsidiaries, <span class="hljs-keyword">and</span> agents, <span class="hljs-keyword">to</span> <span class="hljs-keyword">use</span> your image, story, <span class="hljs-keyword">and</span> any other submitted materials ("Content"). You will continue <span class="hljs-keyword">to</span> own your original Content.
```

You are affirming that

you have the authority to provide consent herein any individuals in the Content other than yourself are over 18, know you are giving GitLab permission to use the Content, and have consented to it being used by GitLab pursuant to this license

You are giving GitLab a non-exclusive license with the right to

reproduce the Content in any form and to use in any presentation of any and all kind whatsoever use your Content without giving credit to you or paying you any fees edit your Content prior to use

By agreeing to these terms, you release GitLab, our employees and officers, and any third-party services that we use to promote your Content from any and all claims, actions or proceedings of any kind, and from any and all damages, losses, costs and expenses, including reasonable attorneys' fees and expenses

relating >to >or arising >out >of the >use >of your Content as contemplated by this license.

You may revoke this authorization at any >time by notifying legal@gitlab.com >in writing ("Revocation"). Revocation will >not affect any actions taken prior >to receipt >of Revocation.

>If you don't agree >to these terms, no further action >is required >and you may [INSERT ACTION >TO DENY; EG >NOT SUBMIT THE FORM]

</details>

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/social-marketing/community-management.md

Community Management is a team effort

In order to communicate and respond to our community effectively, management of responses and conversations is a shared effort between Social Media, Developer Relations, Developer Advocates, various experts, and our Support Teams. The two key teams in our processes are the Social and Developer Relations teams. Both act as either the final point of contact or the responsible party to forward messages to the other teams.

Engaging with team member social Posts

non-executive, non-evangelist, non-brand personality team members

GitLab brand channels provide additional impressions/view, comments, and clicks when engaging with team member social posts. It will be more common for the brand social profile to like or comment on a team member post, because this does not interfere with the editorial calendar, while still providing an amplification. We also leave a small amount of space to retweet/quote retweet users (including Team Members) on Twitter, as this is appropriate for the channel and still aids in our editorial efforts. Shares on Facebook or LinkedIn are highly unlikely, due to the low volume of appropriate content available to be calendared on these channels.

Team member social posts that would be considered for likes or comments from the brand channel include:

- sharing GitLab content that would also be covered by brand channel posts (blogs, event registrations, etc.)
- mentioning GitLab in a conversation with another user
- sharing security or patch releases

Team member social posts that would be considered for retweeting or sharing include:

- promoting a region-wide (EMEA, APAC, etc) event that is or is not currently led by corporate events
- when the author shares their own content (writer of a blog, speaker at an event, etc.)
- breaking changes that were not otherwise covered with brand channel posts
- living or explaining GitLab values or products in a way that is fun or educational
- any posts at the social team's discretion

It is important to note that team member social posts are considered the same pool of content as the greater community. Who's post gets shared is a subjective response from the social team and does not have a specific or repeatable formula, due to the nature of every day social media activity.

Communicating team member posts to the social team

While our team will see every post where the brand handle is tagged, the volume creates a delay. Consider sharing the link to your post in the socialmediaaction channel for the brand team to engage.

Also, consider sharing the link to your post in contentupdates or socialmediaposts for additional awareness, increasing the possibility for other team members to engage with your post.

Responding as the company on LinkedIn for any post

Because of limited API access, it's challenging to engage and respond with posts on LinkedIn that do not directly @mention the company page. However, you can use the following method.

Every specific LinkedIn post from a page or a person has its own URL, like this one. At the end of the URL, there is a string of characters at the end, like 6674298269985767424-4SEx/ from the example above. If you add the following to the end of the post URL when you are an admin of the GitLab LinkedIn page, you'll be able to engage and comment as GitLab.

?actorCompanyId=5101804

The URL example from earlier is

<https://www.linkedin.com/posts/wilspillaneopen-source-social-media-strategies-from-activity-6674298269985767424-4SEx/>.

Adding the actorCompanyId to the url would look like

<https://www.linkedin.com/posts/wilspillaneopen-source-social-media-strategies-from-activity-6674298269985767424-4SEx/?actorCompanyId=5101804>

This URL would allow for GitLab to comment and engage.

Core Social Channel Escalations

This escalation workflow dictates predetermined actions and DRIs for Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, and Instagram

| If...

| Then...

| Who owns the response to the community member?

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| A user tags GitLab in a question or comment that does not require a SME / seems generic or benign | The social team decides whether or not to engage directly on the social channel. This work will usually be done in Sprout, but can be done natively on-channel. | The social team

|

| A user doesn't tag GitLab in a question or comment but mentions "GitLab" in plain text

| The social team does not engage because we have not been invited to respond with an @ mention

| No one - we weren't invited to respond with an @ mention

|

| A user tags GitLab in a question or comment that does require a product-related SME

| Community Operations responds with directions to the forum

| Community Operations

|

| A user tags GitLab in a question or comment that does require a non-product-related SME (think employer brand, remote, etc.) | The social team decides whether or not to engage directly on the social channel and works with the non-product-related SME to craft a response. This work would usually be done in Slack | A response may come from brand channel (the social team) or from an SME in the space (e.g., we tag Darren in response to a question), but the social team owns the responsibility to find a response |

| A user identifies themselves as a free and open source user and tags GitLab in a question or comment that would require assistance | Community Operations responds with directions to the forum

| Community Operations

|

| A user identifies themselves as a paying customer of GitLab and tags GitLab in a question or comment that would require support | Community Operations forwards to support

| Support Team

|

| A user doesn't identify themselves at all and tags GitLab in a question or comment that would require assistance | Community Operations responds with directions to the forum

| Community Operations

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| We receive a message that breaks our code of conduct or that of the social channel

| The receiver reviews the message reports the message via the native tools to the specific social channel as spam, a troll, etc.

| Whoever the receiver is

|

Channel and Source Ownership

Channel	Source	Tool
Who Reviews?		
Review Cycles		Justification
Note		

A set of handwriting practice lines consisting of four rows of three horizontal lines each (top solid, middle dashed, bottom solid). Vertical tick marks are placed on the middle dashed line of each row at various positions: the first row has marks at the beginning, one-third, and two-thirds; the second row has marks at one-third and two-thirds; the third row has a mark at one-third; and the fourth row has marks at one-third and two-thirds.

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LinkedIn	Comments	Sprout
Social, LinkedIn App	Social Team	
1-2 times during business; no weekend requirements		While LinkedIn works
7 days a week, our engagement isn't necessary. Most comments are not questions, and users don't have an expectation on a response time for LinkedIn.		
responding directly to a user comment doesn't allow for tagging the user in Sprout (could be a LinkedIn API limitation)		

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Instagram App	DMs	Instagram
1-2 times a day	Social Team	While we don't

receive many messages, what we do get is mentions of being in a user story. With only a 24 hour lifecycle, if we want to engage with users who tag us, we'll need to look at least once a day.

| Not available through a 3rd party tool

|

| HackerNews | Mentions | Zapier +
Slack | Community Operations, Developer Evangelism, Team
Member Experts

| via notification in Slack | no cycle is

necessary because notifications happen live

| notifications in hn-mentions channel, requires a personal account to respond

|

| Reddit | Mentions | Zapier +
ZenDesk | Community Operations, Developer Evangelism, Team
Member Experts

| via notification in Slack | no cycle is

necessary because notifications happen live

| requires a personal account to respond

|

| StackOverflow | Mentions | Zapier +
ZenDesk | Community Operations, Developer Evangelism, Team
Member Experts

| via notification in Slack | no cycle is

necessary because notifications happen live

| requires a personal account to respond

|

| GitLab Forum | New User Posts | Zapier +
Slack | Community Operations, Developer Evangelism, Team
Member Experts

| via notification in Slack | no cycle is

necessary because notifications happen live

| notifications to the gitlab-forum channel

|

| YouTube (both channels) | Comments on our videos | YouTube App

| We need to identify who owns these channels, whether or not we want comments on, and how often they need to be checked. This has been a crack in our workflows for many teams. | -

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| there is no community management function available in 3rd parties

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Community Management on Instagram

It is worth calling out platform specifics for Instagram in our handbook because the channel does not operate like any other Brand Social Channel. Since Instagram is a visual first platform, we take an editorial approach that prioritizes brand awareness, and 1:1 conversation. This is GitLab's opportunity to share real team member stories, and express our values.

One of the challenges we face as an all-remote organization on Instagram, is that we typically have lower quality images. We have to depend on team members and their cell phone photos. So our approach to each post is to be authentic. Don't filter the image. These are photos of real offices or experiences, and portray actual team members.

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
 Sizes & Ratios
</summary>

When posting to the Instagram feed, you can tap the expand/zoom feature at the bottom left of your photo. This will allow your photo to appear in a 1.91:1 ratio or 1080x608 pixels. If there are no sizing issues, then the photo can remain in a 1:1 ratio or 1080x1080 pixels.

When posting multiple photos to your feed post, think about which image will receive most engagement. That image should display first. Hint: team members and their pets or families engage really well!
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<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
 Caption
</summary>

We choose to use long form captions on our Instagram page because it allows us to provide our community an authentic story. Make sure to always give credit when do. This can be simply done by adding - Name, Title at the end.
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<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
 Post consistently
</summary>

Instagram is an unrealistic channel for GitLab to post every single day on. That is why we develop themes to live by during a given period. For each campaign launched, you should post once a week.

Always post at THE optimal time. Because we don't post multiple times a day on Instagram, you have the opportunity to schedule each week at the 5 start stime that Sprout Social recommends. This will guarentte that your post is published at the peak time and with the most eyes on it.
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<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
 Use hashtags
</summary>

We noticed that posts with a group of hashtags increased the reach of each feed post. So by using hashtags, your post will be discovered through the Explore Page. Each theme or campaign you run, should start with hashtag research. Once you've determined your tags they should be added at the end of every single caption. Don't forget to add a space between the caption and the tags. Otherwise they will be visually distracting.
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<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
Respond and engage
</summary>

Make sure to always respond or engage with your community each chance you get. The GitLab Brand Instagram provides a unique opportunity to foster 1:1 conversation or interaction. Because we don't post every day- it is likely there are only a few comments. That's why you should like or comment on every single one that isn't an automated bot. Remember to have fun and be relatable in these moments. Even a simple "thanks + an emoji!" can go a long way.

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<summary markdown='span'>
Strategically Post Stories
</summary>

Because we only post weekly, a great way to increase accounts reached, content interactions, and followers is to post a Story related to the feed post you shared recently. After new interactions slow down, post an Instagram story that repackages the content for our audience. If you are sharing a quote, you can use this template.

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SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/social-marketing/open-source-social.md

Open Social Media Strategies

GitLab-based social media strategies to aid in developing your own social media department.

Updates coming soon!

High Impact World Events; Going "dark", pausing posts

In times of crisis, it may be appropriate for the social team to pause all brand channel social posts. This is called "going dark", and is a regular part of evaluating whether or not company messaging is appropriate to share at any given time. It is considered good practice to minimize the digital space brands occupy on social media during times of crisis. This can help to not distract social conversation but can also reduce the probability of being accidentally caught up in conversation unintentionally, sounding tone-deaf, or otherwise coming across as insensitive.

When this occurs, time-sensitive posts will be the first to be rescheduled. In the event time-sensitive posts could not be rescheduled, the social team will do what we can to update our stakeholders on what posts won't be published. Non-time sensitive posts will be moved to Sprout drafts, which can then be rescheduled at a later time.

Going dark could have a negative impact on social metrics, depending on the severity and length

of time we're dark. Going dark could also negatively impact specific CTAs if we're relying on organic social to perform. These considerations are a part of making the decision and will be communicated as often as appropriate.

Here's what you need to get started.

Plan

- No product/promotional messaging across company channels
 - Organic brand social channels
 - Paid social media advertising using brand channels
 - Executives, leadership, reporters, and personalities
 - Personal posts can continue
 - [insert other channels as appropriate]
- No engagement across brand social media channels
 - No likes at all
 - No comments on posts other than what is deemed necessary for triage, in mentions only
- Inform your team of this pause, immediately
- Determine if it's appropriate for your company to issue a statement or to communicate actions being taken
 - You will need to work with others on your team, and in many cases a communications leader and/or executive to make this decision
 - Create a process that allows you to write, approve, and publish a public statement within 24-48 hours. This means identifying all appropriate stakeholders beforehand (for example, do you need legal review?), and perhaps creating new workflows to enable expedited approvals
 - In the first day, review all drafts and future posts for copy and creative that is out of touch with the new reality
 - Be conservative with this review - rewrite or remove anything that could be viewed as inappropriate

Why These Recommendations

- If you need to question your brands' involvement in the story of the moment, you need to pause all publishing to assess the situation correctly.
- Many high impact events and social movements are intended to be brand-free and it's ultimately your responsibility to consider the risk in inserting your brand into the conversation
- There is minimal risk in pausing for up to 48 hours while you and your team assess the situation as it progresses. Take this action liberally.

Timeline

- Immediate and hard pause for 36 to 48 hours to assess the situation
 - You will need every hour of this time to make sure that your team understands the risks involved and to make a sound a decision
- In this short pause, you'll need to determine next steps - a longer pause based on the event progression or another option
- Use the "How do we turn back on" section below for more guidance on evaluating your pause

In the future, many high impact events will cause a 1-3 week pause; there may be times when

going on and off is necessary; don't be afraid of piecing together an unconventional strategy. Continue taking on work that is timeless or can be scheduled at a later date - be ready to insert this content, if appropriate, when you are ready to resume publishing.

Impact on Business

A longer than 48 hour pause does come with an adverse reaction. Campaigns could (and likely will) be impacted negatively because of this recommendation. We may need to consider what it means to continue pausing paid social, blog publishing, etc., or reevaluating the channels and methods of communications (moving from broadcast to 1:1).

How do we "turn back on"?

- Keep tabs on and consider what other companies in your space and top brands (Starbucks, Apple, Coca-Cola, McDonald', etc) are doing and not doing. -- Understanding the landscape helps us to see what others' are making mistakes on and whether or not it's "acceptable"
- Keep a pulse on the movement -- what are we seeing in real life on social media; our feelings on this are as important as our observations
- Include diverse perspectives and a diverse set of people in the conversation - invite people from other teams to provide their feedback, especially if your team lacks diversity; this is non-negotiable
- Input and consideration from leaders that handle external communications
- (Not so heavy but still important) consider goals and initiatives - it will be easier to pause some campaigns more than others
- Consider soft-launching - hobble together light posts at a reduced volume to "ramp back up"

Adopt the DRI concept

At GitLab, we use the Directly Responsible Individual concept to drive our work. The DRI might be a manager or team leader, they might even be an executive. Or, they may themselves be individually responsible for fulfilling all the needs of their of social media - maybe you are the DRI. Make this decision during the evaluation time after the immediate pause. This person is responsible for taking all feedback and the event progression in mind, along with the info in the "How do we turn back on" section to make the decision to begin publishing on social media again or to extend your pause. Be intentional about naming (or claiming) the DRI.

SECTION: